Los Angeles Times

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CHRISTINA HOUSE Los Angeles Times

ROUND AND ROUND IT WILL GO

Plans are underway to make the 100-year-old Griffith Park carousel operational again. Theme park designers will participate in the effort, which could take years and cost millions of dollars. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Saudis facing grim choice as attacks escalate

Houthis' strikes upend ambitious plans to make the kingdom a business powerhouse.

BY NABIH BULOS

BEIRUT — This wasn't the way the story was supposed to go for Saudi Arabia. In recent years, headlines about the country focused on the scale of its ambition, or the fantastical giga-projects girding Vision 2030, the full-steam-ahead drive to remake the kingdom into a business and entertainment powerhouse.

But all that was upended Saturday, when a Houthi missile lanced through Terminal 3 of the capital's international airport, killing 13 people, including a U.S. national, and wounding more than 300 others.

The attack — the deadliest Saudi Arabia has endured in years — made real a war that for most Saudis had remained notional.

It also laid bare the bevy of bad scenarios facing Saudi leaders as they contend with an increasingly formidable enemy that, unlike them, has little to lose.

That the Houthis are able to score hits from 500 miles away, despite the Saudi military spending tens of billions of dollars on multilayered air defense systems, has puzzled experts.

"To me it's shocking. Yes, the Houthis have gotten better, but it's not a matter of them using a new weapons system," said Wolf-Christian Paes, an associate fellow at the London-based International Institute for Strategic Studies.

"The problem must be on the Saudi side," Paes said. "Something must have gone horribly wrong and continues to go horribly wrong."

Videos on social media Saturday showed passengers trudging slowly in a security line before the missile hit, sending them sprinting through the smoke-filled terminal, pieces of debris raining around them.

Although Riyadh's King Khalid International Airport was shuttered after the attack — more than 99% of flights were canceled, according to the aviation analytics firm Cirium — the

[See **Saudi Arabia,** A3]

Democrat won't 'be silenced' by search of home

Rep. Ilhan Omar of Minnesota is targeted by federal agents just weeks from election.

BY ERIC TUCKER AND ALANNA DURKIN RICHER

WASHINGTON — Federal agents on Monday searched the home of Democratic U.S. Rep. Ilhan Omar, a startling escalation in a criminal investigation that brings renewed scrutiny to the frequent target of Trump administration derision in the final weeks of her reelection bid.

In a statement on X on Monday, Omar called the search an "attempt to target political enemies and weaponize federal law enforcement."

"For ten years, Trump has targeted me with baseless lies and smear campaigns. This is just the latest escalation in his campaign of political intimidation," she said. "I will not be silenced."

The search of the Minnesota congresswoman's home so close to next month's midterm contests that will determine control of the House and the Senate was swiftly condemned by top Democrats in Congress and raised questions about the timing given longstanding Justice Department protocol to avoid overt investigative steps involving political candidates in the direct run-up to an election.

"For years, Donald Trump and far-right extremists have relentlessly targeted Congresswoman Omar with vile personal attacks and baseless accusations," said a joint statement issued from House Minority Leader Hakeem Jeffries and other top congressional Democrats. "Now, less than 30 days until the midterm election, his violent mass deportation machine has descended upon the home of a duly elected Member of Congress and her family."

The Justice Department confirmed in a statement that Homeland Security Investigations agents executed a judicially authorized search warrant in the Washington area in connection with an ongoing federal criminal investigation but provided no other details.

The nature and scope of the investigation were unclear, though officials in Trump's administration have repeatedly hinted at the existence of an inquiry targeting Omar, a Somali-born Democrat whose left-

[See **Omar,** A6]

Record Pacific hurricane activity is battering state

Systems reshaping coast as more havoc is expected

BY HANNAH FRY

A season of tropical storms and hurricanes with record-breaking energy in the Pacific Ocean is battering the Southern California coastline.

Researchers at Colorado State University confirmed Monday that storms this summer have generated a higher level of accumulated cyclone energy than ever recorded, surpassing the prior seasonal record set in 2018. The metric is a measure of the total wind energy, intensity and duration of tropical storms and hurricanes.

"It's been a wild season," said Daniel Cayan, a climate researcher at the Scripps Institution of Oceanography at UC San Diego, noting that parts of Southern California's coast already have experienced significant damage ahead of any winter storms in store for the region amid the strongest El Niño on record.

The historic Long Beach boardwalk buckled after a barrage of storms over the last month. As Tropical Storm Rachel approached the coast over the weekend, powerful waves slammed into oceanfront homes, leaving some on the verge of collapse.

In Newport Beach, water from a massive swell — double the size that was initially predicted — blasted through 20-foot berms erected at the beach and inundated roads with about a foot of seawater ahead of Rachel's arrival.

Elsewhere along the coast, the continuous battering from higher-than-normal ocean levels and strong waves this summer has washed away sand, profoundly altering the Wedge in Newport Beach, as well as beaches in San Onofre, Laguna Beach and San Clemente. The coastal damage has been so significant that Orange County declared an emergency last month.

The exceptionally active hurricane season in the Pa-

[See **Storms,** A14]

Awards shows look to streaming for new red carpet

BY STEPHEN BATTAGLIO

For decades, awards shows were the most glamorous events on television.

Annual events such as the Oscars and the Emmys gave viewers a front-row seat to their favorite stars in designer clothes, while music award shows featured the hottest artists performing live.

But in recent years, the shows have become money losers and the network TV business — faced with a decline in viewers that is squeezing profits — is cutting them loose.

The latest evidence of that surfaced last week when the TV Academy announced a six-year deal with Amazon Prime Video.

Amazon will be the home of the Emmy Awards next year, ending more than seven decades of the ceremony airing on broadcast networks. The Oscars are headed to YouTube in 2029, as ABC passed on renewing its rights deal, ending a relationship that dates to 1961, interrupted only by a five-year return to NBC in the 1970s.

They join the other trophy shows that have headed to streaming platforms in recent years. The Actor Awards (formerly known as the Screen Actors Guild Awards) moved to Netflix in 2024, after a test run on the streamer's YouTube channel the year before, after more than two decades on TNT and TBS, while the Academy of Country Music Awards show has been on Prime Video since 2022, having ended its run on CBS.

The reasons behind the shift to streaming are clear. The shows no longer deliver the ratings necessary to at-

[See **Streaming,** A10]

Today's exotic catch courtesy of El Niño

Wahoos? Devil rays? Some weird creatures spotted off SoCal coast

BY FEDOR ZARKHIN



GARY CORONADO For The Times

DECKHAND Eric Munoz tags bullet tuna for visitors on the Dana Pride. It's a rare fish in these waters.

Captain Brandon Erdo steered the 95-foot Dana Pride up to a patch of water that looked promising miles off the Orange County coast on a Wednesday morning.

The boat was near capacity — 37 of 40 available angler spots were taken. And, after hearing on social media about the great fishing to be had with the super El Niño, they wanted in on the action.

"Get a little bait going here, Eric," Erdo said over the loudspeaker, as a deckhand hopped onto a tank of anchovies, scooped them and hurled them overboard, raining tiny translucent scales onto the deck and anglers' backs.

"First fish!" shouted veteran angler Chuck Freeman, reeling in an approximately 2-foot-long shimmering bullet tuna — his first time catching one in 47 years of fishing the Pacific.

Minutes later, he pulled in another and tossed it with the others, their tails thwapping the deck, painting it red with blood.

According to scientists, the super El Niño conditions

[See **Catch,** A14]

San Diego is considering using AI to help officers write police reports

BY LIBOR JANY AND JAKOB MCWHINNEY

Earlier this year, the San Diego Police Department made headlines for a policy that prohibited officers from using artificial intelligence to produce police reports. Now the department is opening the door to doing just that.

A request for information issued by the department on July 31 said it was looking for a program "that utilizes AI technology to assist officers and investigators in writing police reports."

"The goal of this initiative is to enhance efficiency in report writing, thereby allowing officers to respond more quickly to calls for service," the request for information read.

It noted that the program must allow users to maintain control over the "content and structure of their reports." It also said the request was issued "solely for information gathering and planning purposes." The document estimated the contract value to be somewhere between $500,000 and $3 million.

In an email, San Diego police spokesperson Ashley Nicholes emphasized that the department was in an "exploration phase" to learn what technology is available and what the best practices are. Should it choose to pursue AI-assisted police report programs, the department would conduct outreach to elected officials and community members, she said.

"SDPD is constantly looking at ways to maximize efficiency throughout the department, particularly

[See **Reports,** A6]



ROBERT GAUTHIER Los Angeles Times

DODGERS DOWN 2-0

After a surprisingly short outing by Yoshinobu Yamamoto, above, L.A. lost to the Brewers 7-4 in Game 2 of the NLCS in Milwaukee. **SPORTS, D1**

Port of L.A. posts a record

The facility moves more cargo during September than in any month in its history. **BUSINESS, A9**

Trump's golf project halted

An angry federal judge ordered a stop to tree-cutting at historic D.C. course. **NATION, A4**

Weather
Mostly sunny.
L.A. Basin: 76/57. **B5**

Markets **A11**
Opinion Voices **A12**

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